

StepCat

Payout Calculator - Quick Start Guide

StepCat Calculator v253.1 + Profitability Workbook v253.4

September 1, 2026 workbook v253.4 completion-cue and validation update

Release note: Workbook v253.4 is the current recommended workbook with StepCat Calculator v253.1. Profitability calculations and report layouts are unchanged; v253.4 adds normalized Payment / Record Type validation, burnt-orange / bronze completion cues for applicable missing A:L inputs, matching Record Review guidance, and continued backward compatibility with older Subscription-style membership records. N:Z retain the pale-blue calculated/protected background; result meaning is shown by text color: green for Profit, dark/black for Draw or zero, and red for Loss, including a paid disqualification.

This guide uses the current StepCat v253.1 workflow and Workbook v253.4 public-blank workbook illustrations. Workbook images contain no personal records. The two What's New illustrations in the migration section are retained only as clearly labeled v253.3 layout examples; the v253.4 release text in this guide is current.

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Fastest workflow: Choose Entry Mode (Step 1), confirm Membership Type (Step 2), complete Game Entry (Step 3), open Review Entry (Step 4), then choose Calculate & Save.

Record-copy rule: When moving existing records, copy only A5:M through the last actual record row. Do not copy unused yellow rows down to the red boundary, and never copy N:Z.

1. Four-step entry workflow

Choose Estimate for a projection or Finalized for a completed result. Membership Type is Step 2 and becomes available after Step 1 is confirmed. Gold indicates the current action; completed steps move to the completed state.

The screen is titled "Entry Mode" in gold. At the top, there are three buttons: "D" (in a gold box), "STEP 1" (in a gold box), and "Required" (in a gold box). Below these, the text reads: "Choose Estimate for a projection or Finalized for a completed result. This is the first required choice." A light blue box contains the text: "Switching modes keeps the current unfinished entry. Use Start New Entry when recording a different challenge." At the bottom, there are two large buttons: "Estimate" (with "Projection" below it) and "Finalized" (with "Completed result" below it). Below these buttons, the text reads: "Tap Estimate or Finalized to confirm this entry."

Entry Mode - Step 1, before a selection.

The screen is titled "Membership Type" in gold. At the top, there is a gold trophy icon. Below it, there are three buttons: "E" (in a gold box), "STEP 2" (in a gold box), and "Required" (in a gold box). Below these, the text reads: "Estimate selected. Confirm Member or Non-Member (Step 2) to continue." There are two large buttons: "Non-Member" (with a person icon) and "Member" (with a star icon). Below these buttons, the text reads: "Selection required - tap Member or Non-Member for this entry." At the bottom, there is a button labeled "Show Math".

Membership Type - Step 2 after Estimate is selected.

Current Settings labels: Remember Estimate / Finalized Mode, Remember Game Entry Layout, Remember Membership Choice, and Remember Payment / Record Type.

2. Game Details and Calculation Information

Step 3 uses focused subsections in Guided Sections mode. Use Continue to move to the next subsection and Back to return to the previous one. Your entered values remain in place as you move between sections. Show All Fields displays the complete Step 3 form. Amount fields accept no more than two digits after the decimal. The example below is an Estimate for Step Marathon.

Game Details
Identification, dates, notes, and copied-date format

In progress

Game Name
A Optional
\$100 Step Battle

Game Start Date
B Optional
08/03/2026
Selected start date: 08-03-2026

Game End Date
C Optional
08/16/2026
Selected end date: 08-16-2026

Payment / Record Type
F Optional
Points

Notes
M Optional
Optional notes, e.g. Original entry:
\$13.85 cash and 26.15 points

Copied Date Format
Web
MM-DD-YYYY

Continue to Calculation Information

Game Details for the \$100 Step Battle example. Continue moves forward without clearing entered values.

Calculation Information
Pot, entry fee, and player counts

Complete

Required fields must be completed for the selected Entry Mode. Optional fields may remain blank.

Gross Pot
G Optional
50700

Entry Fee
H Required
100

Eligible Players
I Optional
460

Total Players
J Optional
507

Back Continue to Final Result

Calculation Information for the same finalized example: 50,700 pot, \$100 fee, 460 eligible players, and 507 total players.

Estimate rule: An Estimate does not require Final Earned / Chips. Finalized entries require the completed result unless Disqualified / Lost Entry Fee is selected.

3. Review, Calculate & Save

When required Step 3 values are ready, choose Review Entry. In Guided Sections, Step 3 collapses and dims as a completed group so Step 4 Review becomes the visual focus. Step 4 shows the complete record before anything is saved. Use Edit beside any review group to return to the exact section that needs a correction, or Continue Editing to reopen the current Step 3 subsection.

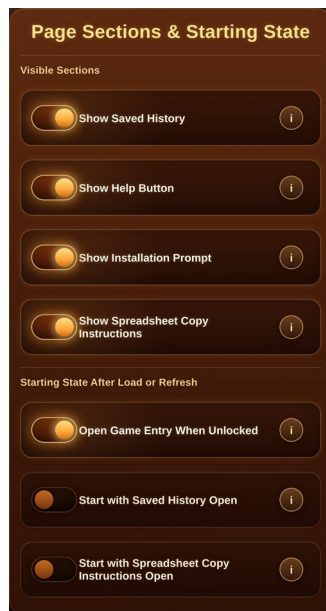
Step 4 Review shows all completed values together before Calculate & Save creates the Saved History record.

After a successful save: the completed fields remain visible for review during the current session, while that completed record is removed from unfinished-draft recovery. Use Start New Entry when you are ready to reset the form.

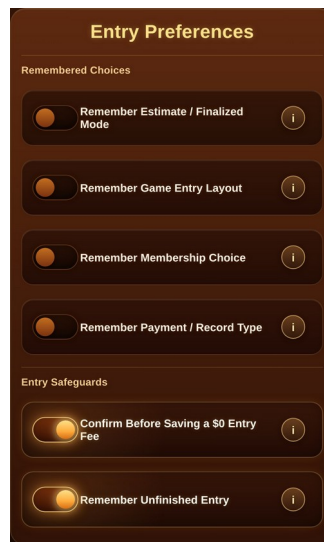
Before you save: Opening Review Entry does not save anything. A Saved History record is created only after you choose Calculate & Save.

4. Settings

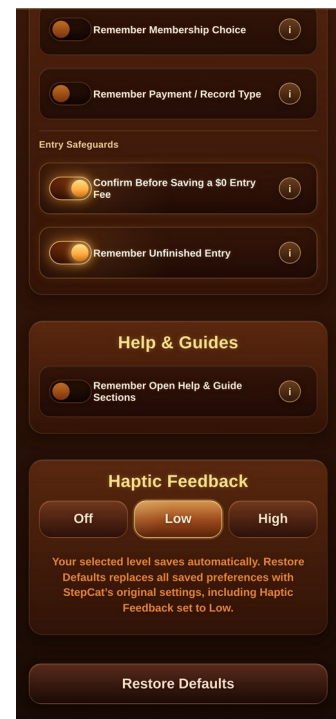
Ordinary setting changes save automatically. Restore Defaults is the bulk reset action. These are the current v253.1 Settings groups and labels.



Page Sections & Starting State.



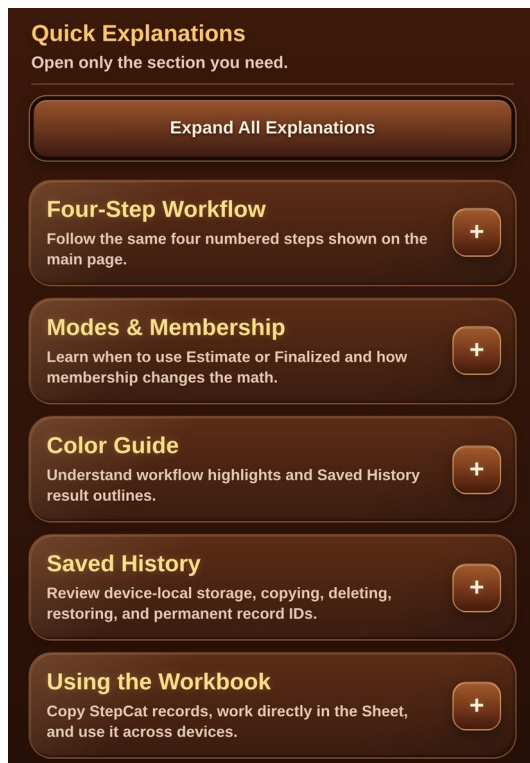
Entry Preferences and Entry Safeguards.



Help & Guides, Haptic Feedback, and Restore Defaults.

5. Help & Resources

Quick Explanations use the current topic name Using the Workbook. Guides & Workbook contains the current HTML guides, the Workbook v253.4 Google Sheets link, migration dialog, PDF, and editable DOCX.



Quick Explanations overview.



Guides & Workbook with the current Workbook v253.4 link, migration help, PDF, and editable DOCX.

6. Using the workbook

The Google Sheet is the permanent cross-device record. Enter or paste A:M only. Leave N:Z untouched so protected formulas calculate results and reports automatically.

Using the Workbook

Copy StepCat records, work directly in the Sheet, and use it across devices.

Copying StepCat Records

Complete Step 4, save the record, then use **Copy This Sheet Row**. Paste it into the first empty column-A cell in Game Records.

Using the Workbook Without StepCat

The calculator is optional. Enter or paste values in A-M; leave N-Z untouched so the workbook can calculate its results and reports.

Spreadsheet Apps & Devices

Google Sheets provides the complete StepCat formulas, reports, automatic saving, and access from devices signed into the same Google account. Other spreadsheet apps can hold copied rows for basic recordkeeping, but may not reproduce the StepCat formulas or reports.

Adding Records on Mobile

To add a record between existing records, insert a whole worksheet row above the desired position and enter or paste A-M. The red ACTIVE RECORD BOUNDARY moves down temporarily. When finished, delete the same number of unused blank rows immediately above the red boundary to return it to row 505. Never delete the red boundary itself.

Direct workbook use, devices, and mobile row insertion.

Move Existing Records to the Current Workbook

You do not have to migrate solely because Workbook v253.3 exists. Earlier corrected workbooks can continue to calculate, but v253.3 is the current recommended public workbook. If you want the final row-height consistency fixes or are replacing an older/problematic copy, first open the current v253.3 workbook. Then copy from **A5 through the last row that actually contains a record**—for example, A5:M198 if row 198 is your last record—and paste into **A5** of the current copy. You do not need to select unused yellow rows down to the red boundary. If blank rows occur between existing records, include them in the selected range so the record order is preserved.

Computer: use *Paste special* → *Values only*.
Phone or tablet: regular Paste is acceptable when only A-M are selected.

No Carryover is needed merely to update. Carryover is for starting a fresh workbook after all 500 active record positions are actually filled.

The current workbook supplies its own protected N-Z formulas, so calculated columns rebuild automatically from the transferred A-M values.

WARNING
Do not copy N-Z, headers, entire rows, entire sheets, reports, or charts.

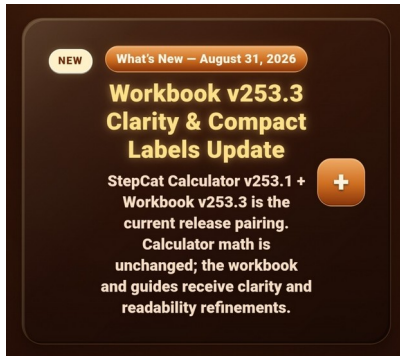
[Open Detailed Instructions](#)

Current Move Existing Records guidance for transferring A5:M safely into Workbook v253.4.

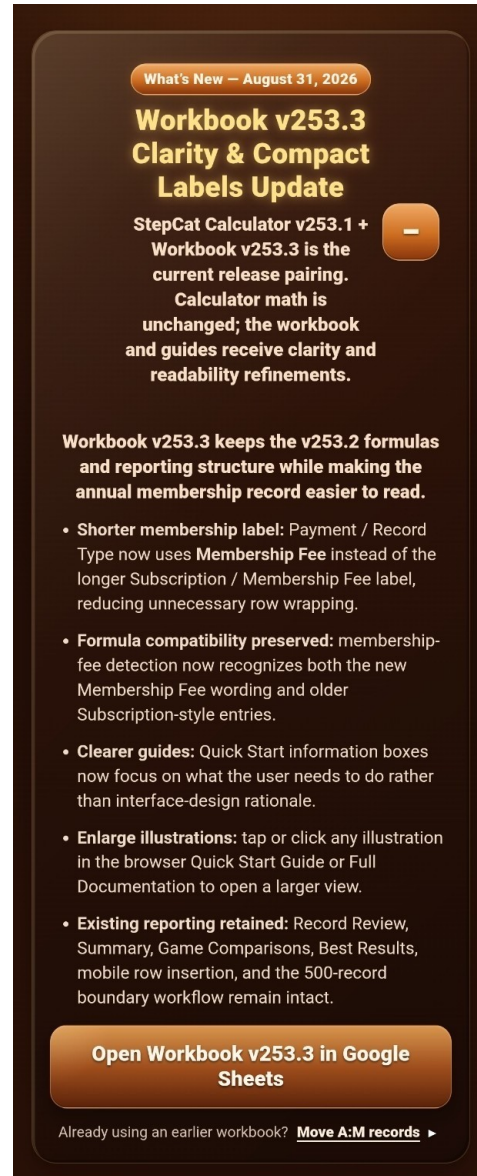
Mobile insertion: Insert a whole worksheet row above the desired position, enter or paste A:M, then remove the same number of unused blank rows immediately above the red boundary so it returns to row 505. Never delete the red boundary itself.

7. Workbook update and migration

Workbook v253.4 is recommended. Profitability calculations and report layouts remain unchanged. v253.4 normalizes Payment / Record Type validation, adds burnt-orange / bronze completion cues for applicable missing A:L inputs after a record is started, and aligns Record Review with the same applicable field checks. N:Z keep their pale-blue calculated/protected background; result meaning is shown by number/text color: green for Profit, dark/black for Draw or zero, and red for Loss, including a paid disqualification. Membership Fee and Free Game / Chips exceptions remain intact, and older Subscription-style membership records remain backward-compatible.



Previous v253.3 What's New card layout example. The current v253.4 update text is reproduced in this guide rather than altering the historical screenshot.

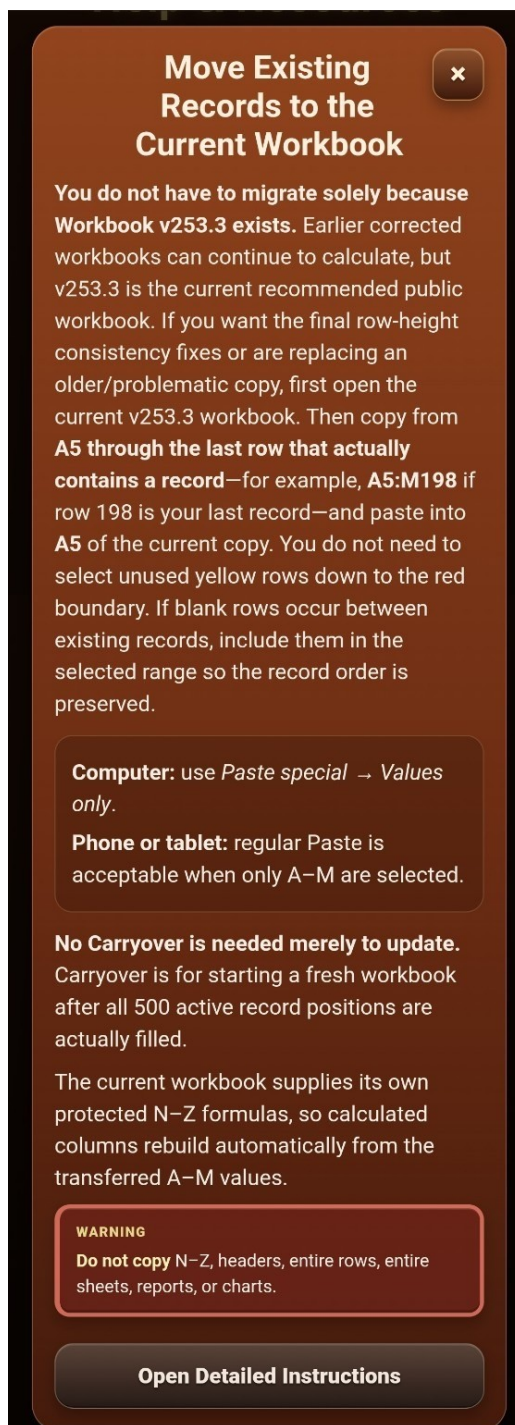


Previous v253.3 expanded What's New layout example. Workbook v253.4 now describes completion cues, normalized validation, Record Review alignment, and unchanged profitability reporting.

- Copy A5:M through the last actual record row (for example A5:M198 if row 198 is the last record).
- Do not select unused yellow rows down to the red boundary. Include blank rows that occur between existing records.
- Computer: Paste special -> Values only. Mobile: regular Paste is acceptable when only A:M are selected.
- Do not copy N:Z, headers, entire rows, entire sheets, reports, charts, or the red boundary.
- No Carryover is needed merely to update. Carryover is for a fresh workbook after all 500 active record positions are actually filled.

8. Move Existing Records dialog

The corrected mobile dialog opens at its true top, scrolls to its true bottom, keeps an accessible close control, and browser/Android Back closes the dialog before leaving StepCat.



Current Move Existing Records dialog with A5:M transfer guidance and the N-Z warning.

9. Google Sheets workbook - Instructions

Workbook screenshots use the current public blank Workbook v253.4 export and contain no personal records.

StepCat Workbook Instructions — v253.4	
Google Sheets working version with insertion-safe expanding formulas and migration guidance.	
Start here	Create one Google Sheets copy for everyday use. Enter or paste records in Game Records A:M beginning at row 5. N:Z calculate automatically and must not be edited.
Cross-device use	The Google Sheet is the permanent cross-device record and can be maintained directly without StepCat. Open the same Sheet on any device signed into the same Google account, enter or paste A:M, and leave N:Z untouched so the workbook calculates automatically. StepCat's unfinished fields, settings, and Saved History remain in the current browser/device and do not transfer automatically.
Editable columns	Use A:M for record information. N:Z are generated by protected expanding formulas anchored above the record area. Once a record row has been started, applicable required inputs in A:L turn burnt orange / bronze until completed; untouched blank rows remain pale yellow / cream, and M (Notes) remains optional.
Correcting an existing record	Edit only the incorrect A:M input cells on the existing Game Records row. N:Z recalculate automatically. Do not replace, clear, or edit the calculated cells.
Desktop transfer or relocation	On a computer, copy only populated A:M values. Insert a whole destination row, select its column-A cell, and use Paste special -> Values only. Confirm N:Z, Record Review, and totals before deleting the original row.
Mobile transfer or relocation	On mobile, the easiest way to add a record between existing records is to insert a whole worksheet row above the desired position, then enter or paste A:M. The red ACTIVE RECORD BOUNDARY moves down temporarily. Afterward, delete the same number of unused blank rows immediately above the red boundary to return it to row 505. Never copy an entire row because it includes N:Z.
Profit rule	Enter the total payout returned by the platform in Final Payout / Chips, not profit alone. Example: a \$40 entry with \$3.36 profit is entered as \$43.36. Profit means Result Earned is above Entry Fee.
Draw rule	A normal completed paid game earning the Entry Fee or less is treated as a Draw with \$0.00 net profit. The exact raw estimate remains visible in Estimated Earned.
Loss rule	A monetary loss occurs only when Disqualified / Lost Entry Fee is Yes on a paid entry; the full Entry Fee is counted as lost.
Membership fees	For the annual platform membership, select "Membership Fee," enter the annual cost in Entry Fee, and set Disqualified / Lost Entry Fee to No. Gross Pot, Eligible Players, Total Players, and Final Payout may be entered as N/A because this is a non-game expense. Membership Fee rows do not change Running Net Game Profit; Summary subtracts membership fee costs separately when calculating Actual Running Net Profit.
Free games	Select "Free Game / Chips" for a completed free-entry challenge or a record that awards chips/game credit. Enter chips in Final Payout / Chips when known. Choose No in Disqualified / Lost Entry Fee for a completed free game and Yes only if it was disqualified. Game Type may be N/A only when historical membership status is unavailable.
Summary	Summary uses exact counts and cash totals. Free Games are shown separately from paid-game Profit, Draw, and Disqualified counts, and their chips are reported in a separate non-cash total.
Game Comparisons	The paid table compares Member, Non-Member, Unclassified, and All Paid Games. A separate Free Game Chip Performance section shows completed, disqualified, chips-earned, eliminated-player, and elimination-rate statistics. Membership Fee rows are excluded.
Gross Profit Earned	The sum of positive paid-game cash profit before subtracting lost entry fees or membership fees. Free Game chips are excluded.
Net Game Profit	Gross paid-game cash profit minus total lost entry fees. Free Game chips are excluded from cash net profit.
Actual Running Net Profit	Running Net Game Profit minus current and carryover membership fee costs. Free Game chips remain separate.
Calculated/result colors	Columns N:Z keep their pale-blue calculated/protected background. Result meaning is shown by the number/text color rather than by changing the result cell to a colored box.
Green text	Profit
Dark / black text	Draw / zero
Red text	Loss, including a paid disqualification
Pale blue background	Calculated / protected cells in N:Z
Burnt orange / bronze	In A:L, flags a required input or selection that is still missing after a record has been started. Notes (M) remains optional.
Mobile copy and paste	On mobile, ordinary Paste is acceptable only when the copied selection contains A:M values and no calculated columns. A StepCat Copy Sheet Row paste is preferred because it contains record values only. Confirm that the destination row's N:Z results appear automatically.
Starting Midyear	Choose one continuation method: transfer prior A:M records to preserve full detail, or use Carryover Setup for totals only when you are not transferring those rows. When transferring records, copy only from row 5 through your last actual record row—for example, A5:M198 if row 198 is your last record. You do not need to copy unused yellow rows down to the red boundary. Include any blank rows that occur between existing records, but never copy N:Z or the red boundary row.
Workbook capacity	The Google Sheets version supports a maximum of 500 active records, normally entered in rows 5–504. The ACTIVE RECORD BOUNDARY is intended to remain at row 505. If whole rows are inserted above it, the boundary moves temporarily; remove the same number of unused blank rows immediately above it to return the boundary to row 505. When all 500 active record positions are actually filled, start a fresh workbook and use the Carryover alternative.
Editing, inserting, and deleting	A:M are editable; N:Z are calculated. To add a record between existing records, insert a whole worksheet row above the desired position and enter or paste A:M. The red boundary may move down temporarily. After inserting rows, delete the same number of unused blank rows immediately above the red boundary to restore it to row 505. Never delete the red boundary itself, and do not use Delete cells and shift left or up.
In-progress / ready-to-finalize status	Estimate rows are marked automatically by End Date. Blue End Date / Entry Mode cells mean the game is still in progress, including its listed End Date. Amber means the End Date has passed and the record is ready to check and finalize. Red means an Estimate is missing a usable End Date. Record Review shows the same status in words. These markers are informational only and do not change calculations.

Workbook v253.4 upper Instructions section showing the bronze missing-input cue, calculated/result color key, Membership Fee wording, and workbook safeguards.

9A. Lower Instructions and Carryover alternative

Calculations	Reference for how the workbook determines results and totals.
Member games	Adjusted Pot uses 100% of Gross Pot.
Release date	September 1, 2026
What's new as of September 1, 2026	Workbook v253.4 normalizes Payment / Record Type validation throughout the workbook and adds burnt orange / bronze completion cues to the A:M input area. Once a record is started, applicable required cells in A:L are highlighted burnt orange / bronze until completed, while untouched rows stay pale yellow / cream and Notes remains optional. Record Review now reports the same applicable missing fields, including Game Name and finalized Free Game disqualification status. Membership Fee and Free Game / Chips exceptions are preserved, older Subscription-style records remain backward-compatible, and profitability calculations and report layouts remain unchanged.
Profit	Result Earned above Entry Fee; Net Profit is Result Earned minus Entry Fee.
Draw	A normal completed paid game earning the Entry Fee or less records \$0.00 Net Profit while preserving the exact Estimated Earned or Final Payout amount.
Disqualified	Paid entry: Final Payout / Chips and Result Earned / Chips should show \$0.00, and the full Entry Fee is recorded as lost. Free Game: the disqualification status is preserved, 0.00 chips are earned, and no monetary Entry Fee loss is recorded.
ROI	Net Profit divided by Entry Fee. When Entry Fee is \$0, ROI displays N/A because division by zero is undefined.
Running Net Profit	Prior Net Game Profit plus current-workbook cash Net Profit, accumulated row by row. Free Game chips do not change the total; Draw and Membership Fee rows may repeat the preceding total.
Membership Fee effect	A Membership Fee row is excluded from game counts and game results. Its cost does not change Running Net Game Profit and is subtracted separately when calculating Actual Running Net Profit.
Earlier compatibility change — v253.0	Introduced in v253.0: native Google Sheets table types for calculated columns N, O, and T were corrected so those columns can display either numeric results or the intentional text N/A without false red validation warnings. Formulas, inserted-row inheritance, dropdowns, visible borders, number formatting, and profitability calculations were unchanged.
Adding, correcting, or relocating a record	Correct an existing record directly in A:M. To relocate or insert one, insert a whole row at the destination, paste only A:M into column A, and confirm N:Z populate. Desktop: use Paste special -> Values only. Mobile: use StepCat Copy Sheet Row or copy only A:M and use regular Paste.
Removing an unwanted record	Deleting the entire worksheet row is safe in the current workbook because N:Z are generated by expanding formulas anchored above the record area. Clearing A:M is also safe but leaves a blank row. Never delete only some cells and shift neighboring cells.
Verification after changes	Confirm the calculated Result, Net Profit, Running Net Profit, Record Review, and Summary. If N:Z do not populate, immediately undo the insertion or paste. Do not copy formulas into N:Z or sort the entire workbook as a repair step.
Protected formula area	Do not edit, paste into, clear, or copy N:Z. Do not alter the formula anchors in row 3. Ordinary record work should be limited to A:M and whole-row insertions or deletions.
Preferred correction method	For one or two wrong fields, edit those A:M cells directly. For a fully rebuilt or moved record, recalculate it in StepCat, use Copy Sheet Row, paste at the destination, verify calculations, then delete the old whole row.
Previous release — August 31, 2026	Workbook v253.3 shortened the annual membership Payment / Record Type to Membership Fee, preserved backward compatibility with older Subscription-style records, and refined workbook and report readability without changing profitability formulas.

Workbook v253.4 lower Instructions section showing the September 1 release note, calculation definitions, compatibility notes, and protected-formula safeguards.

Carryover is an alternative, not an update step: If you transfer prior A:M records into the current workbook, leave Carryover values at zero. Use Carryover only when starting a fresh record list without transferring the prior rows. Prior Game Count includes completed games only; exclude Membership Fee rows and unfinished Estimate rows.

10. Game Records A:M and N:Z

[illegible]

Game Records A:M - input columns only.

The image shows a screenshot of a Microsoft Excel spreadsheet. The top row is highlighted in yellow and contains the following text: "Introduction of Management Information Systems in a Business Process". Below this header row is a large grid of cells. The grid is divided into two main sections: a yellow section on the left and a blue section on the right. The yellow section is further divided into columns labeled "Date", "Time", "Location", "Activity", "Duration", "Frequency", "Priority", "Status", "Owner", and "Notes". The blue section is further divided into columns labeled "Date", "Time", "Location", "Activity", "Duration", "Frequency", "Priority", "Status", "Owner", and "Notes". The grid is empty, with no data entered.

Game Records A:M farther down the sheet with rows 1-4 frozen.

11. Record Review, Summary and Best Results

StepCat Live Summary Dashboard — v253.4						
Game Result	Game Count	Share of Paid Games	Cash / Credit Total	Amount	What It Represents	
Profit Games	0	0.0%	Running Net Game Profit	\$0.00	Gross profit minus lost entry fees	
Draw Games	0	0.0%	Gross Profit Earned	\$0.00	Positive paid-game cash profit only, before lost fees or membership costs	
Disqualified Games	0	0.0%	Total Lost Entry Fees	\$0.00	Full entry fees lost from disqualification	
Current Workbook Paid Games	0	0.0%	Memberships	\$0.00	Annual membership cost, tracked as a separate non-game expense	
Prior Completed Games (reference)	0		Actual Running Net Profit	\$0.00	Running cash net game profit minus current and carried over membership costs	
Completed Free Games (separate credit)	0	Separate	Free Game Chips Earned	0.00 chips	Non-cash chips/game credit earned from Free Games; excluded from every cash profit total	

Summary dashboard with exact counts and financial totals.

[illegible]

Running Tally with exact counts and shares.

Record Review – Game Index and Field Review – v253.4															
Lists each game record except Membership Fee rows, automatic Estimate finalization status, and fields that may deserve review. N.Z. use expanding formulas anchored above the record area.															
Game #	Game Records ID	Game Name	Calculated Result	Finalization / Review Status	Blank Fields to Review	Notes from Game Records	Review Totals								
							Total Games	0							
							Profit Games	0							
							Draw Games	0							
							Disqualified Games	0							
							Free Games	0							
							Points Games	0							
							Cash / Hybrid Games	0							
							In Progress	0							
							Ready to Finalize	0							
							Estimate Date Issues	0							

Record Review v253.4 with result totals, Estimate timing status, and the same applicable missing-field checks used by the Game Records completion cues.

Best Results — Live Reference Table — v253.4			
Shows notable highs, lows, and record extremes found in Game Records. Values update automatically when records are added or changed.			
Metric	Game	Value	Meaning
Highest Net Profit			Largest positive cash profit from one paid game
Smallest Positive Net Profit			Smallest cash profit above \$0 among profitable games
Highest ROI			Highest return on Entry Fee among profitable paid games
Lowest Positive ROI			Lowest positive return among profitable paid games
Largest Lost Entry Fee			Largest full Entry Fee lost to disqualification
Lowest Elimination Rate			Lowest recorded elimination percentage among finalized games, including a true 0%
Highest Elimination Rate			Highest recorded elimination percentage among finalized games
Longest Challenge			Most weeks in a finalized challenge
Shortest Challenge			Fewest weeks in a finalized challenge
Largest Player Field			Highest Total Players value among finalized games
Most Players Eliminated			Most players eliminated from one finalized game
Largest Paid-Game Gross Pot			Largest Gross Pot among paid game results
Highest Free-Game Chips Earned			Most chips/game credit earned from one completed Free Game

Best Results v253.4 live reference table.

12. Installation, feedback, and troubleshooting

Installation

Use the hosted StepCat page in a supported browser. When installation is unavailable, use the Installation information and Add to Home Screen guidance. A local test page may not offer the same installation controls as the hosted site.

Feedback

Write Feedback prepares a message for your email app. Review the recipient, subject, and message before sending.

Troubleshooting

Calculate does not continue: Correct the highlighted field. StepCat identifies the first blocking value.

Free Game fee is rejected: Use Entry Fee 0 for Free Game / Chips, or choose another Payment / Record Type.

Membership or Entry Mode resets: Enable the matching Remember setting or make a fresh selection.

Saved entry appears as unfinished work: Current v253.1 removes a completed saved record from unfinished-draft recovery while leaving the completed fields visible for review during the current session.

Copied row does not calculate: Paste into the destination column-A cell and only across A:M. N:Z should calculate automatically.

Switching devices: Open the same Google Sheet on the other device. StepCat Saved History, settings, and unfinished fields do not automatically transfer.

Move Existing Records behavior: The current dialog keeps Close reachable, supports full scrolling, and browser/Android Back closes the dialog before navigating away.

Release check: After deployment, close old StepCat tabs/apps, reopen the hosted site, confirm StepCat v253.1 is displayed, open the public Workbook v253.4 link, and verify that the current v253.4 downloadable guides load.